

for international banks, who were hiring big at the time, or the foreign service. I had no interest in working for a corporation.

Did you actually look for a job after you received your master's?

My kids say, "Dad, you never even tried looking for a job." And, in a sense, they are right. I did go for a number of interviews with banks after I graduated, but I just felt I wasn't the right person to get into that environment. There was something holding me back from being interested.

What appealed to you about being a stockbroker?

It was the high energy.

Had you learned anything by the time you became registered as a stockbroker?

I had a friend who had been trading stocks since he was a kid. After I became a stockbroker, he told me, "Joe, you don't know anything." But I had a lot of enthusiasm. He was right, though, I didn't know anything. I was probably dangerous to my customers. I was literally following the firm's research, but if you work for a firm that has bad ideas, you don't have a chance.

When did you begin trading?

I am not a cold caller. It's not in me to call someone up and try to solicit business. I am not a salesman. Never have been; never will be. I'm, actually, the exact opposite. I never made much in commissions, but then my three best accounts all disappeared for different reasons. An old-time trader I knew advised me that I should ask my boss permission to trade my own account. I took his advice and went to my boss and said, "Can I set up my own trading account because I really don't have any other income?" [He laughs harder and louder than usual at this recollection.] He offered me a deal to set up my own account with the authority to carry up to \$30,000 in positions overnight, providing I put up \$2,000 of my own money. I would be allowed to keep any profits, and the firm would keep all the commissions. That sounded like a good deal to me. I did okay, averaging about \$4,000 a month.

Any trades stand out from that time period?